

Memory Bar*

The Memory Bar NDA (Figure 8J) makes a good companion to the CPU Use NDA. In graphic form, it shows you just how much of your computer's memory is in use and how much is available for use. Unlike the Finder's "About The Finder," the Memory Bar NDA is available within all Desktop applications, because it's an NDA.

The yellow portion of the bar represents the amount of memory in use. The green portion represents the amount of memory that is in use but will be released if another program needs it (purgable memory). The pink portion indicates the largest *contiguous* block of memory available—how much memory a program can allocate all at once (MaxBlock). And the white area represents how much memory is not in use but is not included in MaxBlock (the white and pink bar together represent free memory).

To find out exact memory sizes for any of the bars, click on the bar you're interested in or press the numbers 1-5. You can also use Tab to cycle through the available bars.

Click the "Compact" button to get rid of as much purgable (green bar) memory as possible and make it available for reuse by the system. Usually you won't need to use the "Compact" button because the system will give up purgable memory as it's needed. However, you may find this button useful before launching some memory-hungry programs.

Warning!

Don't compact memory while you're running AppleWorks GS. Evidently that program marks part of its memory as purgable when it really isn't. Compacting memory is a good way to crash AppleWorks GS.

Memory Bar is public-domain software by Dave Lyons.

Minstrel*

Minstrel (Figure 8K) allows you to play SoundSmith and SynthLab songs in Desktop programs while you continue to work! It's like a jukebox for your IIGS. SynthLab is a program included with System 6 for recording and playing back high-quality music. Now you can listen to those songs any time you like.

Minstrel keeps track of a list of songs in its "jukebox." To add a song to its jukebox, click the Insert button (you'll have to do this first because there are no songs in the jukebox to begin with). Using the Standard File dialog, open a SoundSmith or SynthLab song. It appears in the list. Add any other songs you might want to listen to, too. You can add as many as you want from one folder—hold down the Shift key while clicking to select all the files from the current selection to the click location; use the ⌘ key while clicking to select and unselect individual files. Click Accept to add the files you selected. (To remove a song from the list, click "Eject.")

To play a song, select it from the list and click the "Play" button. To play all the songs in the list in a random order, click "Shuffle." To repeat the currently playing song, click the "Repeat" button. The "Rewind," "Forward," and "Pause" buttons are functional during playback. "Stop" works just as you'd expect.